



“We have 700,000 stores registered on the platform, of which 200,000 are active on an average every month. In terms of sales, we are doing around ₹65 crore every month, with over 700,000 transactions”

JASMEET THIND

CO-FOUNDER,
COUTLOOT



“We started NE Origins during the pandemic in January last year and in less than a year, we have 400 sellers from the North-east and we are registering a month-on-month growth of 15 per cent in our revenues”

REWAJ CHETTRI

FOUNDER & CEO,
NE ORIGINS



“Social commerce is growing rapidly and is here to stay. Like how e-commerce was nascent in 2006, social commerce is at that nascent stage currently. But it looks very promising from an investment point of view”

SANJAY MEHTA

FOUNDER &
PARTNER, 100X.VC



“Social commerce will influence at least \$100 billion worth of business in the next two to three years. Brands that stay away will see business dip. Every brand/seller will have to embrace it”

ALOK CHAWLA

CO-FOUNDER &
COO, KIKO

early-stage investment firm. “If we want to increase adoption of technology-led commerce, then this is the frontier that we have to cross. If you have to bring the next 100 million consumers into e-commerce, whether it is ordering, engaging or transacting, then you will need a strategy to integrate social commerce into your thinking.”

Data from Tracxn, a start-up data platform, shows that a little over a billion dollars—\$1.15 billion to be precise—was raised by social commerce platforms in India in 2021 by way of 22 funding rounds. It was an exponential jump from the mere \$60.5 million that was raised in 2020 through 13 funding rounds. Furthermore, a cumulative amount of \$286 million has been raised through five funding rounds by social commerce platforms this year till April.

Mehta of 100X.VC strongly believes that social commerce is growing rapidly and is here to stay. “There is a good amount of services start-ups that are coming up in this space. Several new models are emerging in the social commerce space. Like how e-commerce was nascent in 2006, social commerce is at that nascent stage currently. But it looks very promising for investors to fund the social commerce space,” says Mehta.

The platforms that are new and native to the social

commerce space will be far more growth-oriented than ventures or people who have their own websites or are old-school in their approach, he adds.

THE FINAL WORD

There is absolutely no denying the fact that social commerce is here to stay—globally as well as in India. But given the street-smart Indian shopper, social commerce platforms will have to continue to innovate and offer buyers an experience that is as close to real-life shopping as one can get in the digital world.

A report by management consulting firm Bain & Company pegged India’s social commerce GMV at around \$2 billion in 2020, which was estimated to reach \$20 billion by 2025 and further jump to \$70 billion by 2030 on the back of a large mobile phone user base.

Further, it is estimated that currently 95 per cent of all retail commerce happens physically and the coming years could see at least 50 per cent of all physical retailers get into some kind of digital presence. This offers a phenomenal opportunity of growth for the social commerce players.

Exciting times lie ahead of us. **BT**

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